11.2 Basic Syntax and Usage

Laravel's Query Builder is designed to be intuitive and readable. It allows you to construct SQL queries using method chaining, which results in clean and fluent syntax. At its core, Query Builder starts with the `DB::table()` method, where you specify the table you want to query. From there, you can chain additional methods to build up your query logic.

To begin using the Query Builder, you first need to import the `DB` facade:

```
use Illuminate\Support\Facades\DB;
```

11.2.1 Selecting Records

The `get()` method is used to retrieve all matching records as a collection:

```
$users = DB::table('users')->get();
```

To select specific columns, use the `select()` method:

```
$users = DB::table('users')
            ->select('name', 'email')
            ->get();
```

If you need only a single record, use the `first()` method:

```
$user = DB::table('users')->where('id', 1)->first();
```

11.2.2 Filtering with Where Clauses

The `where()` method is used to add conditions to the query. It can be chained multiple times to apply multiple conditions:

```
$activeUsers = DB::table('users')
                ->where('active', 1)
                ->where('role', 'admin')
                ->get();
```

You can also use comparison operators:

```
$users = DB::table('users')
           ->where('age', '>', 25)
           ->get();
```

11.2.3 Ordering, Limiting, and Offsetting